Design identity for human, workload, and agent principals



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Checking in with Globomantics



Supply chain wants an agent that reorders parts on its own

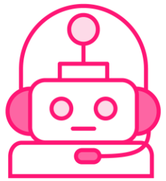
It writes to the ERP system for a planner who may be asleep

Connected Equipment ships every two weeks

What identity does the agent use, and who is accountable?

Give an AI agent an identity you can govern

An agent is a principal, not a feature



It acts continuously, often with no human present at the moment of action



Microsoft Entra Agent ID supplies the identity constructs to govern it



Its permission is permanent by default, which is what makes it a target

The architect's read on agent governance at scale

“A policy attached to an agent identity blueprint covers every agent derived from it, including next quarter's.”

Reference: Microsoft, “Conditional Access for agents”, learn.microsoft.com/entra/identity/conditional-access/agent-id

Apply Conditional Access to each agent access pattern

The access pattern decides the policy target



On behalf of a user: the user is the token subject, so policy targets users and groups

As an application: the agent uses its own credentials, so policy targets the agent identity

With its own user account: policy targets that account, and all-users policies never include it

Microsoft Learn, Conditional Access for agents

“Because the user is the subject in this flow, Conditional Access policies target users and groups, not agent identities.”

Citation: Microsoft, “Conditional Access for agents”, learn.microsoft.com/entra/identity/conditional-access/agent-id

Design access across SaaS, PaaS, IaaS, hybrid, and multicloud

One estate, three control families

Combine identity, network, and application controls rather than choosing among them

Consolidate on Microsoft Entra ID as the primary identity provider

Weigh Microsoft Entra Cloud Sync against Microsoft Entra Connect for the inherited forest

The unowned AWS estate needs an owner before it needs a control

Separate B2B collaboration from decentralized identity

Two external identity trust problems

B2B collaboration	vs.	Decentralized identity
Microsoft Entra External ID		Microsoft Entra Verified ID
The partner organization is known		The claim travels with the holder
You govern the relationship		The verifier never contacts the issuer
Trust anchors to their tenant		Trust anchors to the credential

Demo: Govern an agent identity with Conditional Access

Examine an agent identity and the policy governing it in the Microsoft Entra admin center, then review a Conditional Access estate against Zero Trust intent

Relevant SC-100 practice question

Block a high-risk agent without nightly approvals

Question

An autonomous agent writes to ERP nightly with its own credentials. All users require MFA. How do you block it at high risk?

A. Rely on the existing all-users MFA policy

B. Target the agent identity and block high risk

C. Give the agent a licensed user account instead

D. Restrict the ERP app to a named location only

Block a high-risk agent without nightly approvals

Answer: B

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Checking out with Globomantics



Give every agent an identity you can name and govern

Match the policy target to the access pattern

Combine identity, network, and application controls

Split B2B collaboration from decentralized identity